

festival

Theatrical Treat

HYDERABAD In what is slated to be the biggest cultural festival of performing artistes in Hyderabad, the city is readying itself for a major theatrical treat. The Qadir Ali Baig Theatre Festival is back and has in its bag of offers popular classics as well as international productions from Pakistan and France.

Taking a cue from last year's success when the festival featured Naseeruddin Shah, Girish Karnad and Jabbar Patel, this year the theatre foundation offers a repertoire of comedies, tragic accounts, social dialogues on child abuse and racism, as well as historical tales in this one-festival-offers-all package. The foundation has been instituted in the memory of Mirza Qadir Ali Baig, an accomplished actor, director, producer and playwright, who gave up a life full of privileges to devote himself to the cause of theatre. He laid the foundation of the New Theatre of

Hyderabad in 1970, his theatre repertory, and sustained it till his death in 1984 at the age of 46. His son Mohammed Ali Baig continues to promote theatre under the aegis of the foundation.

The festival opens at the Darbar Hall of the Raj Bhavan with the reading of Qadir Ali's play *Aadmi Ki Keemat* by his son on October 30. It moves to the Hyderabad International Convention Centre (HICC) on October 31 with M.S. Sathya's *Girija Ke Sapne*, followed by Alyque Padamsee's *Unspoken Dialogues* on November 1. On November 2, the venue shifts to Ravindra Bharathi, where plays like Mohammed Ali Baig's *Raat Phoolon Ki*, Usman Peerzada's *Nawab Sahib Qibla*, Ismail Choonara's *Question Mark*, Habib Tanvir's *Charandas Chor*, Sohaila Kapur's *Ouch!* and Larry Tremblay's *Lecon D'Anatomie* from France will be performed. Except the last two, all other plays are family productions. A visual treat, indeed.

by Amamath K. Menon

WIRY ENERGY: A scene from the play *Question Mark*



art exhibition

Missing Pieces

KOLKATA Missed Call, a 15-day exhibition by C. Douglas, showcases paintings with images of disjointed mannequins, broken ladders and phones with their receivers off the hook, almost imposing a sense of something missed on the viewer in a powerful yet subtle way. The viewer starts to feel that he or she is waiting for something, anticipating a missed call. The recurring image of the phone with its receiver off the hook has been used by the artist not only to represent the very literal meaning of a missed call, but also isolation and a desire to avoid contact with fellow human beings. The image of a man with his ears bandaged can also be interpreted as someone who wants to live in a world of silence. Douglas' interest in philosophy is evident in his juxtaposition of images with words that almost create a world of their own as if the paintings have a verbal connection with the viewer. At Akar Prakaar. On display till November 10.

by Elora Sen

VERBAL CONNECTION: Works by Douglas



exhibition

An Unbound Idea

MUMBAI Believing that art is neither titillation, nor information or reduction, Neeraj Gupta's sculptures utilise ancient sculptural motifs in fresh contemporary incarnations. In his current solo exhibition, *Enduring Stones* Deep Wood, Gupta uses life-size sculptures in stone and wood and gives them an imaginative treatment that lends a sense of timelessness



A sculpture on display

ness to the works. At Jehangir Art Gallery. On from November 1.

by Swati Mathur